Awang Had Salleh
Graduate School
of Arts and Sciences

Universiti Utara Malaysia

POSTGRADUATE RESEARCH ETHICS APPLICATION FORM

PROPOSAL TO BE SUBMITTED WITH THIS APPLICATION FORM

NO.	DETAILS	REMARKS
1.	Background of Study	
2.	Objectives	
3.	Problem Statement	
4.	Methodology (please ensure that you include detailed descriptions of your approach to enable the reviewer to understand your methodology such as sample size, target populations, tools used, questionnaires, statistical methods, confidentiality matters, risks and mitigation steps and any other issues that will aid the review of your application)	
5.	Flow Chart	
6.	Gantt Chart	
7.	Expected Outcomes	
8.	List of Related Publication(s), if any	

NOTE:

Only complete applications will be processed. Incomplete applications or those with insufficient information will not be considered.

Applicants are advised to submit their applications at least three (3) months in advance of the intended date, as the process involves multiple stages.

SECTION A: RESEARCHER INFORMATION

Student Name	:	
Matric No	:	
Level of Study/ Programme	:	
Tel. No.	:	
School	:	
Email Address	:	
Supervisor Name(s)	:	1. 2. 3.

SECTION B: PROJECT OVERVIEW

Thesis/Project Title	:	
Start Date	:	

Expected End Date	**:**	
Type of Study:	**:**	☐ Quantitative ☐Qualitative ☐ Mixed
Data Collection Methods	**:**	☐ Surveys ☐ Interviews ☐ Observations ☐ Existing Data ☐ Other: _____
Location(s) of Research	**:**	
Funding Source (if applicable)	**:**	

C: RISK ASSESSMENT

Will your research involve any of the following?	
Vulnerable population (e.g: children, adolescents, elderly, refugees)	☐Yes ☐ No
Emotional or Sensitive topics	☐Yes ☐ No
Clinical/medical data/psychological procedures	☐Yes ☐ No
International participants/sites	☐Yes ☐ No
Incentive for participation	☐Yes ☐ No
Audio/video recording	☐Yes ☐ No
Risk Level: *(Kindly refer to the Appendix 1 – Risk Assessment Rubric)*	☐ No risk ☐ Low risk ☐ High risk

SECTION D: CONSENT & DATA PROTECTION

Will informed consent be obtained? (Attach sample consent form)	☐Yes ☐ No (please specify)
Will participants be allowed to withdraw?	☐Yes ☐ No
Will results be shared/published?	☐Yes ☐ No
How will data be stored and protected?	
Publication and Authorship Integrity Authorship Agreement: Have you and your supervisor formally agreed on the order of authors and criteria for inclusion? (If applicable)	☐Yes ☐ No

Important notes:
Please attach:

i) **The data collection letter issued by your school**
ii) **Information and consent form**

Journal publication confirmation (if relevant)

SECTION E: DECLARATION BY RESEARCHER

I declare that the information provided in this application is accurate to the best of my knowledge, and that I will conduct this research in accordance with ethical guidelines and institutional policies.

Researcher's Signature**:**	Date :

SECTION F: SUPERVISOR'S ENDORSEMENT

I have reviewed this ethics application and confirm that the proposed research complies with acceptable ethical standards.

Main Supervisor	**Co-Supervisor**
Name:	Name:
Signature:	Signature:
Date:	Date:

SECTION G: FOR OFFICE USE (Ethics Committee)

Application Received On	**:**
Reviewed By	**:**
Decision	**:**
Comments/ Conditions (if any)	**:**
Signature (Chair/Secretary)	**:**
Date	**:**

SECTION H: FOR AHSGS

Application Received On	**:**
Endorsement Date	**:**

V1

INFORMATION AND CONSENT FORM

NAME OF RESEARCHER:

Topic of the Research	
Overview of the Study *(general summary)*	
Purpose of the Study *(significance of the study)*	
Participants Criteria	
Study Procedures	
Risks *(direct or indirect risk to the participants/their partner)*	
Participation in the Study	

Name:
Occupation:
Address:
Phone no:
Signature:
Date:
Stamp:

V2

INFORMATION AND CONSENT FORM

1. Thank you for volunteering in this interview/observation/survey/experiment.

2. The interview/observation/survey/experiment is conducted as part of the ***(name of the researcher, research's title, provide a brief overview and the purpose of the study)***.

3. This consent form is given to the participants to ensure their rights to their opinions if they wish to withdraw from the interview/observation/survey/experiment they may do so without any consequences. Their opinions are their own and do not reflect the person conducting the interview/observation/survey/experiment.

4. The venue and time for the interview shall be determined by your good self and shall be at your convenience in regards of place and time.

5. I understand that the researchers remain the anonymity of the participants in the study. Subsequent uses of records and data will be subject to standard data use policies which protect the anonymity of individuals and institutions.

6. For any inquiries. Please contact ***(researchers number/email address).***

7. I have read and understand the content of this form.

Name:
Address:
Phone number:
Signature:
Date:
Stamp:
***The respondents will be given a copy of this form.**

SAMPLE

RISK ASSESSMENT RUBRIC

INTRODUCTION

In research, risk is generally evaluated by the probability and magnitude of harm. This rubric gradates the criteria from No Risk (no foreseeable harm beyond everyday life), to Low Risk (minimal risk, where any discomfort is temporary and manageable), to High Risk (greater than minimal risk, with potential for significant psychological, social, legal, or physical harm).

RESEARCH RISK ASSESSMENT RUBRIC

Criteria	No Risk (Negligible / Everyday Risk)	Low Risk (Minimal Risk)	High Risk (Greater Than Minimal Risk)
1. Vulnerable Population (e.g., children, adolescents, elderly, refugees)	**General Adult Population:** Participants are competent, independent adults capable of providing fully informed, voluntary consent without coercion.	**Mildly Vulnerable or Requiring Standard Safeguards:** Includes older adolescents (with parental consent), independent elderly, or general college students. They require standard ethical protections but can understand the risks.	**Highly Vulnerable Populations:** Includes young children, cognitively impaired elderly, refugees, asylum seekers, or wards of the state. These groups have diminished autonomy, may fear authority, or cannot legally consent, requiring strict, specialized safeguards.
2. Emotional or Sensitive Topics	**Neutral / Everyday Topics:** Topics are benign and unlikely to cause any emotional discomfort (e.g., consumer preferences, general daily habits, non-sensitive demographic data).	**Mildly Sensitive Topics:** Topics may cause transient, mild discomfort or boredom (e.g., general work stress, mild financial habits, recalling minor frustrations). Discomfort is easily managed and resolves quickly.	**Highly Sensitive / Traumatic Topics:** Topics involve trauma, abuse, grief, illegal activities, or deep psychological distress. Discussing these could trigger significant emotional distress, re-traumatization, or psychological harm.
3. Clinical / Medical Data / Psychological Procedures	**Non-Clinical / Observational:** No physical or psychological procedures. Involves only anonymous secondary data	**Standard / Non-Invasive Procedures:** Involves non-invasive physical measurements (e.g., height, weight), standard surveys, or	**Invasive / Clinical Interventions:** Involves invasive procedures (e.g., drawing blood), collecting

	analysis of non-sensitive information, or basic observational studies in public spaces.	reviewing de-identified medical/clinical records. Procedures are routine and carry no physical risk.	identifiable medical/clinical data, administering unapproved drugs, or conducting psychological interventions/therapies that could alter physiological or mental states.
4. International Participants / Sites	**Domestic / Familiar Environments:** Research is conducted in the researcher's home country with participants in familiar, safe environments where local laws and cultural norms are well understood.	**Stable International Sites:** Research is conducted in international sites with stable governments, established research ethics frameworks, and minimal cultural/language barriers.	**High-Risk International Sites:** Research in areas with political instability, weak ethical oversight, war zones, or extreme cultural/language barriers. Includes sites where local laws do not protect data privacy, putting participants at risk of legal or social harm.
5. Incentive for Participation	**No Incentive or Nominal Compensation:** No payment, or standard, nominal compensation (e.g., course credit, a $5–$10 gift card) that simply acknowledges the participant's time without influencing their decision.	**Moderate / Fair Compensation:** Financial compensation that is fair and proportional to the time and effort required. It is not large enough to cloud a participant's judgment or make them ignore potential risks.	**Undue Inducement / Excessive Payment:** Excessively large financial incentives (especially for low-income or vulnerable populations) that could impair a participant's ability to weigh risks, or incentives that encourage participants to hide their eligibility or risks.
6. Audio / Video Recording	**No Recording or Anonymous Observation:** No audio/video recording is used. If recording is used, it is strictly anonymous (e.g., faces blurred, voices altered, or audio immediately transcribed and the raw file destroyed).	**Identifiable but Secure Recording:** Audio/video recording of participants with explicit, informed consent. Data is securely encrypted, de-identified as soon as possible, and destroyed at the end of the study. The content itself is not highly sensitive.	**Covert, Sensitive, or Highly Identifiable Recording:** Covert recording without consent; recording highly sensitive, stigmatized, or illegal behavior; or storing identifiable recordings of vulnerable populations (e.g., children) where a data breach would cause severe social, legal, or psychological harm.